

The Dalmatian Coast

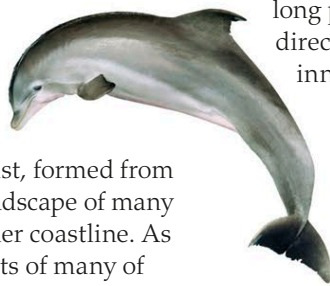
A fractured but highly scenic coast made up of hundreds of islands and straits, set in the azure waters of the Adriatic



The Dalmatian Coast extends down part of the eastern side of the Adriatic Sea (an arm of the Mediterranean Sea) and comprises a large section of the coastline of Croatia. From the seaport of Dubrovnik in the south, the coast meanders in a northwesterly direction for a distance of roughly 230 miles (375 km).

A drowned coast

The Dalmatian Coast is a classic of its type—a particular kind of drowned coast, formed from the submergence of what was once a landscape of many parallel mountain ridges close to a former coastline. As a result of the drowning, the higher parts of many of



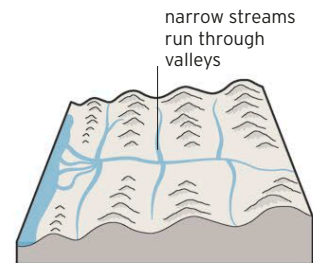
the old ridges are now long, narrow islands running parallel to the present-day coastline. The island of Dugi Otok (Croatian for “Long Island”), for example, is $27\frac{3}{4}$ miles (44.5 km) long, but only 3.0 miles (4.8 km) wide. Other parts of the former landscape are now long promontories, running parallel to the overall direction of the coastline, or have split up into innumerable small islands.

◁ DOLPHIN-DOTTED WATERS

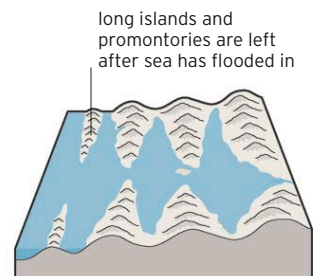
Bottlenose dolphins are the only dolphin species commonly seen around the Dalmatian Coast. These sleek swimmers can reach speeds of more than 20 mph (30 kph).

HOW THE DALMATIAN COAST FORMED

Around 10,000 years ago, the region contained mountains and valleys parallel to the coast. Over time, the rising sea level drowned the area, producing the coastal features seen today.

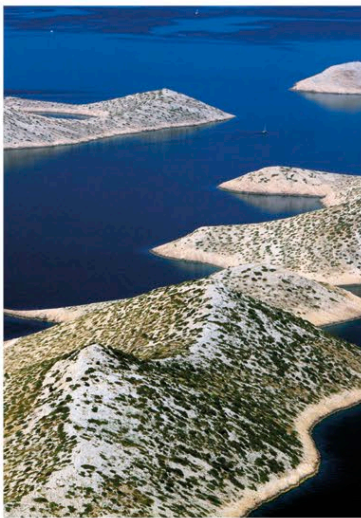


BEFORE SEA-LEVEL RISE OF PAST 10,000 YEARS



AFTER SEA-LEVEL RISE OF PAST 10,000 YEARS

The Dalmatian Coast is one of the **densest archipelagos** in the world



△ PARCHED ISLANDS

This string of islands forms part of the Kornati Archipelago in northern Dalmatia. Their appearance is typical of many small islands of the region.

▷ PRISTINE WATERS

The clear waters and scenic beauty of Stara Baska in the southern part of Krk make it a popular tourist destination.

